MyAccounting — Functional Guide

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> **Who is this guide for?**
> This guide is written for people who run their own business or work as independent professionals — IT consultants, real estate agents, service technicians, or anyone who bills clients for their time and services. You don't need any accounting background to use this guide. Where accounting terms are unavoidable, they are explained in plain language.

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1. What Does MyAccounting Do?

MyAccounting is a Windows desktop application that helps small Canadian service businesses manage the money side of their work. Think of it as a simple office tool that replaces spreadsheets and paper records for billing and financial tracking.

In plain terms, it lets you:

- Send professional invoices to your clients and email the PDF directly from the app
- Record payments when a client pays you
- Track how much each client owes you at any moment
- Log your daily work hours and send approved timesheets to clients
- Run reports to see how much money your business made and where it was spent
- Manage your list of clients, services, and projects in one place

What it does NOT do:

- Pay your suppliers or track bills you owe (accounts payable)
- Process employee payroll
- Track physical stock quantities (it is designed for service businesses)
- Work as a cloud or web application — it runs only on your Windows computer

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2. How the Application Works

What	Details
Runs on	Windows 10 or later (standalone program — no browser needed)
Stores data in	Microsoft SQL Server, installed locally on your computer
Built with	Python — but you don't need to know Python to use it

MyAccounting is a standard Windows desktop application. You double-click to open it, sign in, and use it like any other program. All your data is saved automatically to a local database on your computer — no internet connection is required for day-to-day use (except for sending emails).

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3. Application Structure

The application is divided into separate sections, each handling one area of your business. You switch between them using the navigation menu on the left side of the screen.

Section	What It Handles
Dashboard	Your daily overview — unpaid invoices, recent activity, to-do list
Configuration	All your setup: company info, clients, services, email, users
Invoicing	Creating and sending invoices to clients
Cash Receipts	Recording payments you receive from clients
Journal	Manual corrections to your financial records
Chart of Accounts	Your master list of financial categories
Reports	Profit & Loss, Balance Sheet, and other financial summaries
Timesheets	Tracking daily work hours for billing

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4. Signing In and User Access

4.1 How Sign-In Works

When you open MyAccounting, a sign-in screen appears before anything else. You enter your username and password. If your account is inactive or the password is wrong, the application will not open.

Once signed in, the application remembers who you are for the entire session. It uses your identity to filter your own to-do items, timesheets, and other personal data.

4.2 Password Security

Your password is never stored in plain text. MyAccounting uses industry-standard encryption (the same method used by banks) to protect your credentials. Each password is individually scrambled with a unique random code, so even if someone accessed the database directly, they could not read your password.

4.3 User Roles

Role	What They Can Do
Admin	Full access to everything, including user management and all settings
User / Accountant	Access limited to specific sections, as configured by the admin

4.4 Controlling Who Can Access What

An admin can grant each user either **full access** (read and write) or **view-only access** per section. For example, you might give a bookkeeper full access to Cash Receipts but only view-only access to Configuration.

Sections that can be individually controlled: Financial Categories, Journal, Reports, Configuration, Invoicing, Cash Receipts, Timesheets.

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5. Your Home Screen (Dashboard)

The Dashboard is the first screen you see after signing in. It gives you a quick snapshot of your business at a glance.

5.1 What's on the Dashboard

Panel	What It Shows
What Clients Owe You	A list of clients with outstanding unpaid invoices and the amount due
Pending Adjustments	How many financial adjustments are saved as drafts and not yet finalized
Monthly Revenue Chart	A bar chart showing how much money you earned each month
My To-Do List	Your personal task list — notes, reminders, and follow-ups

5.2 Your To-Do List

The to-do list is personal to each user — no one else sees your tasks. You can:

- Add tasks with a title, notes, due date, and priority (Low, Normal, High)
- Mark tasks as done
- Delete tasks you no longer need

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6. Setting Up Your Business

The **Configuration** section is where you enter all your business details before you start using the other sections. Think of it as your control panel. It is organized into 13 tabs.

6.1 What Each Tab Does

#	Tab	What You Set Up
1	**Company Info**	Your business name, address, phone, website, and logo for invoices and reports
2	**Fiscal Year & Settings**	Your financial year dates, the tax rate you charge (e.g., 13% HST), invoice numbering, and which financial categories map to your bank account, income, and taxes
3	**Clients**	Your complete client list — addresses, contact details, payment terms, and preferred language
4	**Services / Items**	The services or products you bill for, with default prices
5	**Projects**	Project names you can attach to invoices and timesheets
6	**Consultants / Staff**	The people in your business who create invoices and timesheets
7	**Tax Codes**	The tax rates you apply (e.g., HST 13%, GST 5%)
8	**Countries**	Countries for client addresses
9	**Provinces / States**	Provinces and states for client addresses
10	**Payment Terms**	Options like “Net 30” (client pays within 30 days), “Due on receipt”, etc.
11	**Email Settings**	Your outgoing email server so the app can send invoices and timesheets by email
12	**Users**	Add team members, set passwords, and control what each person can access (admin only)
13	**Timesheet Settings**	Default work shift times and whether client approval is required on timesheets

6.2 Welcoming New Users

When you create a new user account, the system automatically sends that person a welcome email with their username, a temporary password, and instructions for signing in.

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7. Invoicing — Billing Your Clients

7.1 What You Can Do

The Invoicing section is where you create and manage all your client bills.

- See all your invoices in a list, sorted by date, client, or status
- Create a new invoice, edit a draft, or cancel one you no longer need
- Add the services you provided, with quantities and prices
- Add text notes or comments directly on the invoice (e.g., "Payment due by end of month")
- Tax (HST) is calculated automatically based on the rate you set in Configuration
- Generate a professional-looking PDF invoice with one click
- Email the PDF directly to your client from within the application
- Attach supporting documents (contracts, photos, reports) to any invoice

7.2 Invoice Numbering

Invoices are numbered automatically starting from a number you set (e.g., INV-1001, INV-1002, etc.). You never need to manually track invoice numbers.

7.3 Invoice Lifecycle

An invoice moves through these stages:

Status	Meaning
Draft	Work in progress — not yet sent to the client
Approved	Ready to send or already sent
Void	Cancelled — kept for records but no longer counted as money owed

7.4 What the PDF Invoice Looks Like

When you print or email the invoice, the PDF includes:

- Your company name, address, and logo at the top
- The client's name and address
- A table of services provided with quantities, unit prices, and amounts
- Subtotal, tax amount (HST), and total due
- Any notes or comments you added

7.5 Emailing Invoices

When you click "Email Invoice", the application sends an email to the client's billing address. The email subject and message body are templates you can customize — for example: *"Please find attached Invoice INV-1024 for $1,200.00 from ABC Consulting. Thank you for your business."*

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8. Recording Payments Received

8.1 What This Section Does

When a client pays you — by cheque, bank transfer, or any other method — you record that payment in this section. This keeps your client balances accurate and updates your financial records.

- See all recorded payments in a list
- Record a new payment: who paid, how much, on what date, and which invoice it applies to
- Add a memo (e.g., “Cheque #4521” or “e-Transfer”)
- Preview the financial entries before they are finalized
- **Finalize (Post)** the payment to lock it in and update your records

8.2 Receipt Numbering

Like invoices, payment receipts are numbered automatically (e.g., CR-1001, CR-1002).

8.3 What Happens When You Finalize a Payment

When you click **Post**, the application:

1. Records the money as received in your bank account category
2. Removes the matching amount from what the client owes you
3. These two entries balance each other out — this is the standard way financial records are kept

> **Important:** Once a payment is finalized, it cannot be changed or deleted. Always preview the details before posting.

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9. Journal Entry

9.1 What This Section Is For

The Journal Entry section is a general-purpose tool for recording financial transactions that don’t go through the Invoicing or Cash Receipts sections. You’ll use it in two main situations:

Recording operating expenses — Any money your business spends that isn’t captured elsewhere. Common examples for IT consultants, real estate agents, and service technicians:

- Software subscriptions (Microsoft 365, cloud tools, CRM)
- Vehicle mileage or fuel expenses
- Office rent, phone, or internet bills
- Marketing and advertising costs
- Equipment purchases or repairs
- Professional fees (accountant, lawyer)

Making corrections and adjustments — When something needs to be reclassified or fixed:

- Moving an expense from one category to another
- Recording a bank fee or interest charge
- Correcting an error from a previous entry
- Recording depreciation at year end (typically done by your accountant)

You don't need accounting expertise for day-to-day expense entries. Your accountant will typically handle year-end adjustments.

9.2 How It Works

Each adjustment entry has:

- A date and description
- Two or more lines specifying which financial categories are affected and by how much
- The total "increases" must equal the total "decreases" before the entry can be finalized — this is a built-in safeguard that ensures your records stay accurate

9.3 Rules

- An adjustment must balance (what goes in must equal what comes out) before it can be posted
- At minimum, you need two lines per entry
- Draft entries can be edited or deleted; finalized (posted) entries are permanent

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10. Financial Categories (Chart of Accounts)

10.1 What This Is

Your Chart of Accounts is simply your master list of financial "buckets" — categories that every dollar in your business gets assigned to. Think of it like the folders in a filing cabinet, where every transaction gets filed in the right place.

Examples from a service business:

- **Bank Account** — Money in your chequing account
- **Accounts Receivable** — Money clients owe you
- **Service Revenue** — Money you earn from your work
- **Phone & Internet** — A business expense category
- **HST Payable** — The tax you collected on behalf of the government

10.2 What You Can Do Here

- See all your financial categories with their current balances
- Add a new category, rename one, or remove one (as long as it has no transactions)
- Click on any category to see every transaction ever recorded in it — a complete history
- Export the full list to Excel, PDF, or CSV for your accountant

10.3 How Balances Are Calculated

Each category shows its current balance, which is calculated as:

- **Starting balance** (from when you set up the system) **plus** all money that increased it **minus** all money that decreased it

This is always calculated live from your actual transaction records, so it's always up to date.

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11. Business Health Reports

11.1 The Three Key Reports

MyAccounting produces three standard financial reports that every business owner should be familiar with:

Report	What It Answers	Covers
Profit & Loss (Income Statement)	"Did I make money this period?"	Your income and expenses for a date range you choose
Balance Sheet	"What does my business own and owe right now?"	Your assets, liabilities, and net worth at a specific date
Trial Balance	"Are all my records in balance?"	Every financial category with its total — used mainly by your accountant to verify accuracy

Profit & Loss is the report most business owners look at regularly. It shows your total revenue, all your expense categories, and what you're left with (net profit or net loss).

Balance Sheet shows a snapshot of your financial position: what you own (cash, receivables), what you owe (taxes payable, any loans), and what's left over.

11.2 Choosing a Date Range

By default, reports cover your full fiscal year. You can change the start and end dates to look at any period — for example, just this month, or the last quarter.

11.3 Saving and Sharing Reports

Each report can be:

- **Printed to PDF** — a formatted, professional document you can send to your accountant or banker
- **Exported to Excel** — for further analysis or your own record-keeping
- **Viewed on screen** — scrollable, interactive view within the application

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12. Timesheet — Tracking Your Work Hours

12.1 What This Section Is For

If you bill clients based on hours worked — as most IT consultants, service technicians, or contractors do — the Timesheet section is where you log that work. It is designed to:

- Record exactly what you did each day, broken down by task
- Calculate total hours automatically
- Produce a professional timesheet PDF you can email to your client for their records or approval
- Import timesheets from a TPG-format file if your staffing agency or client uses that format

12.2 How a Timesheet Works

Each timesheet covers **one month** for **one consultant**. You:

1. Create a new timesheet for the month, linked to a client and project
2. For each working day, enter your start and end times (morning, afternoon, and any overtime)
3. Add work items for each day — a short description of what you did and optionally a task reference number (e.g., an Azure DevOps work item number)
4. Hours are calculated automatically from your start/end times
5. When complete, submit the timesheet for approval

12.3 Timesheet Approval Process

```
Draft  ──[Submit]──►  Submitted  ──[Approve]──►  Approved
                                 ──[Reject] ──►  Rejected

Rejected  ──[Reset to Draft]──►  Draft
Approved  ──[Cannot be changed]
```

- **Draft**: You are still working on it — can be edited freely
- **Submitted**: Sent for review — waiting on approval
- **Approved**: Locked permanently — your official billing record
- **Rejected**: Sent back to you for corrections — you reset it to Draft, fix it, and resubmit

12.4 Emailing the Timesheet to Your Client

With one click, the application generates a PDF of your timesheet and emails it to the client's contact person. If approval is required, the email includes an approval request message.

12.5 Importing Timesheets (TPG Format)

If you receive a timesheet file from a staffing agency (TPG format), you can import it directly rather than entering everything manually. The application supports:

- CSV files
- PDF files (including scanned documents — the app reads them with optical character recognition)
- Excel files

After importing, you see a preview of what was read. You confirm or cancel before anything is saved.

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13. Loading Your Existing Data

If you are migrating from Sage 50 (Simply Accounting) or have data in text files, there is a one-time import tool that can load your existing records into MyAccounting.

13.1 What Can Be Imported

Data	File Format
Your client list	Text file (pipe-separated)
Your service/product list	Text file (pipe-separated)
Your projects	Text file (pipe-separated)
Historical financial transactions	Sage 50 CSV export
Opening balances by category	CSV file

13.2 Important Notes

- This import runs **once only**, when you first set up the application on a fresh database
- It brings in your historical transaction data from Sage 50 and sets starting balances for all your financial categories
- Running it a second time would create duplicate records — don't run it again after setup

14. How Your Data is Stored

14.1 Data Categories

Your business data is organized into logical groups and stored in a local Microsoft SQL Server database:

What	Examples
Financial records	All transactions, account balances, summaries
Invoices	Invoice headers, line items, file attachments
Payments received	Cash receipt records
Adjustments	Journal entry headers and lines
Timesheets	Monthly timesheets, daily entries, work items
Reference data	Clients, services, projects, staff, tax codes, payment terms
System settings	Your company info, email settings, all preferences

14.2 How Everything Connects

Your data is interconnected so the system keeps everything consistent. For example:

- An invoice is linked to a specific client, project, and staff member
- A payment receipt is linked to a client and the invoice it pays
- A timesheet is linked to a staff member and a client

This means if you look up a client, you can trace all their invoices, payments, and timesheets from one record.

14.3 Your System Settings

All your preferences are stored in a settings table. The most important ones are:

Setting	What It Controls
Company name	Appears on all invoices and reports
Fiscal year dates	Default date range for reports
Tax rate	HST percentage added to invoices automatically
Currency	Display currency (default: CAD)
Invoice prefix & starting number	e.g., INV-1001, INV-1002 …
Bank account category	Which financial category is your bank account
Email server settings	Used to send invoices and timesheets by email

14.4 Automatic Numbering

Invoice numbers, payment receipt numbers, and journal entry numbers are all assigned automatically and always increment by 1. You never have to track or assign these manually.

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15. Rules the System Enforces

These are the safeguards built into the application to prevent mistakes.

15.1 General Rules

- All dollar amounts are stored with exactly 2 decimal places
- Dates use the MM/DD/YYYY format throughout the application
- Empty amount fields are treated as $0.00

15.2 Invoicing

- An invoice must have at least one service line before it can be saved
- Tax (HST) is always calculated automatically: Subtotal × Tax Rate = Tax Amount; Total = Subtotal + Tax
- Voided invoices are excluded from the “money owed to you” totals

15.3 Recording Payments

- A payment must include the client, date, amount (greater than zero), and the bank account before it can be finalized
- Once finalized, a payment **cannot** be changed or deleted — it is a permanent financial record
- Finalizing is immediate and updates your financial records right away

15.4 Manual Adjustments

- The total of all increases must equal the total of all decreases before an entry can be finalized — this keeps your books in balance
- At least two lines are required per entry
- Only draft entries can be changed; finalized entries are permanent

15.5 Timesheets

- Each consultant can only have one timesheet per calendar month — no duplicates allowed
- Only Draft and Rejected timesheets can be edited
- Approved timesheets cannot be changed in any way

15.6 Financial Categories

- Category codes must be unique — no two categories can have the same number
- A category that has transactions recorded against it cannot be deleted

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16. Emails, PDFs, and Exports

16.1 Sending Emails

The application can send emails directly from within the program. You configure your outgoing email server once in Configuration → Email Settings, and then the following actions send emails automatically:

Action	What Gets Sent
Click “Email Invoice”	PDF of the invoice attached to an email to the client
Click “Send Timesheet to Client”	PDF of the timesheet attached to an email to the client contact
Click “Support” in the toolbar	A support request email to the application support address
Create a new user	A welcome email with login details to the new user

16.2 Printable PDFs

Every important document in the application can be exported as a PDF:

Document	Layout	What It Contains
Invoice	Portrait	Your logo, client details, service lines, tax, total
Timesheet	Landscape	Consultant details, daily time grid, work descriptions, total hours
Profit & Loss	Portrait	Revenue, expenses, net income — by date range
Balance Sheet	Portrait	Assets, liabilities, and equity at a point in time
Trial Balance	Portrait	Complete list of all financial categories with balances
Financial Categories List	Portrait	All your account categories with opening and current balances

16.3 Excel Exports

If you prefer to work with data in Excel, the following can be exported to `.xlsx`:

- Financial category list (Chart of Accounts)
- All three financial reports (Profit & Loss, Balance Sheet, Trial Balance)
- Timesheet details

Excel files are formatted with styled headers, currency formatting, and appropriate column widths — ready to send to your accountant.

16.4 CSV Exports

Comma-separated files (CSV) can be opened in Excel or imported into other tools:

- Financial category list
- Journal entries
- A standard summary export for your accountant (`exportdir/accountant.csv`)

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17. Installing the Application

Installation is handled by a guided wizard (`deploy.exe`) that sets up everything automatically — including the database engine, database, Chart of Accounts, company profile, and shortcuts.

For full installation instructions, see the dedicated guide:

MyAccountingInstallation.md

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18. Security and Data Protection

Your financial data is stored locally on your computer and protected in the following ways:

Protection	How It Works
Passwords are never stored in plain text	Your password is scrambled using the same encryption standard used by financial institutions. Even a database administrator cannot read it.
Brute-force password cracking is extremely slow	The encryption process deliberately requires significant computation, making automated password-guessing attacks impractical.
Protection against data injection attacks	All queries to the database use safe parameterized statements — the application is protected against common data manipulation attacks.
Your session is private	Once you sign in, your identity is kept in memory only for your current session. Closing the application clears it.
Per-user access control	Each user can only access the sections the admin has granted them. Everything else is hidden and disabled.
Email credentials are stored locally	Your email server password is saved in the local database, not in any source file or cloud service.
No network exposure	The application does not open any network ports. It only makes outbound connections (to send emails). There is nothing for an outside attacker to connect to.
Change history	Every financial adjustment records who created it and when. Cash receipts and invoices also record creation timestamps.

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19. Screen-by-Screen Reference

This section describes every input screen and dialog box in the application, organized by section. It shows exactly which fields appear on each screen, what they accept, and what happens when you save.

19.1 Sign-In Screen

When it appears: Automatically when you open the application.

Field	What to Enter
Username	Your assigned username
Password	Your password (hidden as you type)

Buttons: Sign In, Cancel
Rules: Both fields are required. If your username is not found or the password is wrong, access is denied.

19.2 General Application Screens

About Screen

How to open: Help → About menu item.

Displays the application name, version number, release date, and author. Read-only — no input required.

Buttons: Close

Support Request

How to open: Help → Support Request menu item.

Use this to send a help request directly from the application.

Field	What to Enter
Your Name	Your full name
Contact Info	Your email address or phone number
Type of Problem	Choose: Bug / Error, Question, Feature Request, Performance Issue, Other
Description	Explain what happened or what you need

Buttons: Submit, Cancel
Rules: Name and Description are required. Your email settings must be configured for the message to send.

To-Do Item

How to open: Dashboard → Add To-Do button, or double-click an existing task.

Field	What to Enter
Title	Short name for the task (required)
Notes	Optional details or reminders
Due Date	Date in MM/DD/YYYY format (click the calendar icon to pick a date)
Priority	Low, Normal (default), or High
Status	Open (default), In Progress, or Done

Buttons: Save, Cancel

19.3 Configuration Screens

Company Info

How to open: Configuration → Company Info tab.

Field	What to Enter
Company Name	Your business name as it appears on invoices
Address Lines 1 & 2	Street address
City, Province, Postal Code, Country	Mailing address
Phone, Fax, Email, Website	Contact details shown on invoices
Logo Path	Click Browse to select your logo image (PNG or JPG)

Buttons: Save Company Info

Fiscal Year & Settings

How to open: Configuration → Fiscal Year & Settings tab.

Field	What to Enter
Fiscal Year Start / End	The first and last day of your financial year (YYYY-MM-DD)
Tax Rate (%)	The HST or GST rate you charge (e.g., 13 for 13%)
Currency	Your currency code (e.g., CAD)
Invoice Prefix	The text before invoice numbers (e.g., INV-)
Next Invoice #	The next invoice number to assign
Next Journal #	The next journal entry number to assign
Accounts Receivable Account	Select from your financial category list — this is where unpaid invoices are tracked
Revenue Account	Select the category where your income is recorded
Tax Account	Select the category where collected taxes are held
Cash / Bank Account	Select the category that represents your bank account

Buttons: Save Settings

Email Settings

How to open: Configuration → Email Settings tab.

Field	What to Enter
SMTP Host	Your email server address (e.g., smtp.gmail.com)
SMTP Port	Usually 587 for Gmail/Office 365
SMTP User	The email address emails are sent from
SMTP Password	Your email account password (hidden as you type)
Use TLS	Enter 1 to use secure connection (recommended), 0 to disable
Support Email	The email address where support requests are sent
Invoice Email Subject	The subject line template for invoice emails — you can use {invoice_number}, {customer}, {total}, {company}, {date} as placeholders
Invoice Email Body	The body template for invoice emails — same placeholders available

Buttons: Save Email Settings

Timesheet Settings

How to open: Configuration → Timesheet tab.

Field	What to Enter
Default Shift	Choose a default workday: "8 to 4" (8:00 AM–4:00 PM) or "9 to 5" (9:00 AM–5:00 PM) — both are 7.5 hours
Require client approval	Check this box if you want the timesheet email to include an approval request to the client

Buttons: Save Timesheet Settings

Client Record

How to open: Configuration → Clients → Add Client or Edit Client button.

The client form has three tabs:

Tab 1 — General (Contact Information)

Field	Notes
Company Name	Required — the client's business name
Contact	Primary contact person's name
Address 1 & 2	Street address
City, Country, Province, Postal Code	Location details (province list filters automatically by country)
Phone, Cell, Fax	Phone numbers in (###) ###-#### format
Email	Client's email address
Website	Client's website (click the globe icon to open in browser)
Currency	Filled automatically when you select a country
Type	A label for the type of client (optional)
Client Manager — Name, Phone, Email	The client-side contact who approves timesheets and receives copies

Tab 2 — Shipping Address

Field	Notes
Same as billing address	Check this box to copy the billing address automatically
Country, Province, Address, City, Postal	Alternate delivery address if different from billing

Tab 3 — Settings

Field	Notes
Assigned Consultant	Which staff member manages this client
Revenue Category	Which financial category income from this client is recorded under
Tax Code	The tax rate applied to invoices for this client (e.g., HST 13%)
Credit Limit	Maximum outstanding balance before a warning (optional)
Payment Terms	How long the client has to pay (e.g., Net 30 = 30 days)
Language	English or French (affects invoice language if supported)
Invoice Delivery	How you send invoices: email, mail, fax, or none
Notes	Any internal notes about this client

Buttons: Save, Cancel
Rules: Company name is required.

Service / Item Record

How to open: Configuration → Services → Add Item or Edit Item.

Field	Notes
Item Code	A short code for the service (required, e.g., CONSULT, TRAVEL)
Description	Full description as it appears on invoices
Type	Service or Product
Unit	What you bill in (e.g., hrs, day, each)
Price	Default price per unit
Cost	Your cost for this item (for your own records)
Revenue Category	Which financial category this item's income goes into

Buttons: Save, Cancel

Project Record

How to open: Configuration → Projects → Add Project or Edit Project.

Field	Notes
Project Code	A short unique identifier (required)
Start Date	When the project began (MM/DD/YYYY)

Buttons: Save, Cancel

Consultant / Staff Record

How to open: Configuration → Consultants → Add or Edit.

Field	Notes
Name	Full name (required)
Signature Image	Optional: path to a signature image file for printed invoices and timesheets

Buttons: Save, Cancel

Tax Code

How to open: Configuration → Tax Codes → Add or Edit.

A tax code can have multiple components (e.g., a combined GST + PST code):

Field	Notes
Code	A short identifier like HST or GST (required; cannot be changed after creation)
Name	Full description
Tax Components	A list of individual tax rates — click Add Component to define each one

For each tax component:

Field	Notes
Name	e.g., HST, GST, PST
Rate (%)	The percentage rate (e.g., 13)
Tax Category	Which financial category this tax is collected into

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Country

How to open: Configuration → Countries → Add or Edit.

Field	Notes
Code	2–3 letter country code (e.g., CA, US) — cannot be changed after creation
Name	Country name (required)
Currency	3-letter currency code (e.g., CAD, USD)

Province / State

How to open: Configuration → Provinces → Add or Edit.

Field	Notes
Country	Select which country this province/state belongs to
Code	Short code (e.g., ON, QC, NY) — cannot be changed after creation
Name	Full name (required)

Payment Terms

How to open: Configuration → Payment Terms → Add or Edit.

Field	Notes
Name	A descriptive label (required), e.g., “Net 30”, “Due on Receipt”

User Account

How to open: Configuration → Users (admin only) → Add User or Edit User.

Field	Notes
Username	The login name (required)
Full Name	The person’s display name (required)
Email	Used for welcome emails
Role	Admin (full access) or Accountant (access controlled per section)
Password	Required when creating a new user; not shown when editing
Confirm Password	Must match the password field exactly (new users only)

Buttons: Save, Cancel

Change Password

How to open: Configuration → Users → select a user → Change Password button (admin only).

Field	Notes
New Password	The new password (required)
Confirm	Must match the new password exactly

Buttons: Save, Cancel

19.4 Invoicing Screens

Invoice Editor

How to open: Invoicing → New Invoice, or double-click an existing invoice.

Invoice header:

Field	Notes
Invoice #	Assigned automatically (e.g., INV-1024)
Date	Invoice date in MM/DD/YYYY — click the calendar icon to pick
Status	Draft, Sent, Paid, Cancelled, or Posted
Client	Select from your client list
Project	Select from your project list (optional)
Consultant	The staff member associated with this invoice

Line items — add the services you are billing for:

Use **Add Line Item** to add a service from your list, or **Add Comment** to insert a text note on the invoice (e.g., "Payment due within 30 days").

Each service line shows: Item, Description, Quantity, Unit Price, and Amount (calculated automatically).

Totals are calculated automatically: Subtotal, Tax (HST), and Total.

Buttons: Save, Cancel, Print PDF, Email, Attachments
Rules: A client must be selected; at least one service line is required.

Add / Edit Service Line

How to open: Add Line Item or Edit on a line in the Invoice Editor.

Field	Notes
Service	Pick from your services list (start typing to filter)
Description	Auto-filled; you can change it
Quantity	How many units
Unit Price	Auto-filled from your services list; you can change it
Amount	Calculated automatically (Quantity × Unit Price)

Add Comment Line

How to open: Add Comment button in the Invoice Editor.

Field	Notes
Comment	Any text note to appear on the invoice

Invoice Attachments

How to open: Attachments button in the Invoice Editor.

Attach files (contracts, photos, purchase orders) to the invoice for your own records. Click **Add Attachment** to browse for a file; select and click **Delete Attachment** to remove one.

Print / Select Printer

If you have multiple printers, a dialog appears for you to choose which one to use when printing the PDF.

19.5 Recording Payments

Payment Receipt

How to open: Cash Receipts → New Receipt, or double-click an existing receipt.

Field	Notes
Receipt #	Assigned automatically (e.g., CR-1001)
Date	Date the payment was received (MM/DD/YYYY)
Client	Select who paid
Apply to Invoice	Optionally link this payment to a specific open invoice
Amount	How much was received
Bank Account	Select the financial category for your bank account
Memo	Optional note (e.g., "Cheque #4521" or "e-Transfer")

Buttons: Save, Cancel, Post
Rules: Client, Amount, and Bank Account are required. Clicking **Post** finalizes the record — this cannot be undone.

19.6 Manual Adjustment (Journal)

Journal Entry Editor

How to open: Journal → New Journal Entry, or double-click an existing entry.

Header:

Field	Notes
Entry #	Assigned automatically
Date	Date of the adjustment (MM/DD/YYYY)
Description	What this adjustment is for
Reference	Optional reference number (e.g., a vendor invoice number)

Lines — add the financial categories being adjusted. Each line has:

Field	Notes
Account	Select the financial category
Description	What this line represents
Debit (+)	Amount being added to this category
Credit (−)	Amount being removed from this category

The running total at the bottom shows whether your entry is balanced. The entry cannot be saved until debits equal credits.

Add / Edit Journal Line

How to open: Add Line or Edit Line button in the Journal Entry Editor.

Field	Notes
Account	Select the financial category (start typing to filter)
Description	Brief note for this line
Debit	Amount to increase (leave at 0 if using credit)
Credit	Amount to decrease (leave at 0 if using debit)

Rules: A category must be selected; exactly one of Debit or Credit must be non-zero.

19.7 Financial Categories (Chart of Accounts)

Add / Edit Category

How to open: Chart of Accounts → Add Account, or Edit Account on a selected row.

Field	Notes
Account Number	A unique code (e.g., 1060 for bank, 4000 for revenue) — cannot be changed after creation
Account Name	Descriptive name (required)
Opening Balance	Starting balance when you first set up the system
Balance Type	Dr = normally holds positive values (assets, expenses); Cr = normally holds positive values (liabilities, income)

Transaction History Viewer

How to open: Double-click a category row in the Chart of Accounts.

Shows all transactions posted to that category — date, description, source, amounts. Read-only.

Export Format Picker

How to open: Chart of Accounts → Export button.

Choose: **CSV**, **Excel**, or **PDF** — the export starts immediately.

19.8 Timesheet Screens

Daily Time Entry

How to open: Click on a date cell in the timesheet grid.

Field	Notes
AM Start / AM End	Morning shift start and end times (HH:MM)
PM Start / PM End	Afternoon shift start and end times (HH:MM)
Other Start / Other End	Overtime or additional time period (HH:MM)
Total Hours	Calculated automatically from the six time fields

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Work Item

How to open: Add Work Item button in the timesheet, or double-click an existing work item.

Field	Notes
Description	What work was done that day (required)
Task Reference #	Optional — enter a ticket number, DevOps item number, etc.
Hours	How many hours this specific task took

Import Preview

How to open: Import from TPG File button after a file is selected and parsed.

Shows a preview table of the rows the application read from the file. Review the dates, times, and hours before confirming.

Buttons: Confirm Import (saves the data), Cancel

Client Picker (for Email)

How to open: Email Timesheet button when the client has not yet been linked.

Displays a searchable list of your clients. Type to filter; select one and click **Select**.

19.9 All Screens at a Glance

Section	Screen	Purpose
Sign-In	Sign-In Screen	Open the application
App	About Screen	Application version information
App	Support Request	Send a help request by email
App	To-Do Item	Add or edit a personal task on the dashboard
Config	Client Record	Add or edit a client (3 tabs, 30+ fields)
Config	Service / Item	Add or edit a billable service
Config	Project	Add or edit a project
Config	Consultant / Staff	Add or edit a consultant
Config	Tax Code	Add or edit a tax rate with components
Config	Country	Add or edit a country
Config	Province / State	Add or edit a province or state
Config	Payment Terms	Add or edit a payment term
Config	User Account	Add or edit a user account
Config	Change Password	Reset a user's password
Invoicing	Invoice Editor	Create or edit an invoice
Invoicing	Add Service Line	Add a billable service to an invoice
Invoicing	Add Comment Line	Add a text note to an invoice
Invoicing	Invoice Attachments	Attach files to an invoice
Invoicing	Select Printer	Choose a printer for PDF output
Cash Receipts	Payment Receipt	Record a payment from a client
Journal	Journal Entry Editor	Create or edit a manual financial adjustment
Journal	Add / Edit Journal Line	Add a line to a journal entry
Chart of Accounts	Add / Edit Category	Add or edit a financial category
Chart of Accounts	Transaction History	View all transactions for a category
Chart of Accounts	Export Format Picker	Choose CSV, Excel, or PDF export
Timesheets	Daily Time Entry	Enter start and end times for a workday
Timesheets	Work Item	Add or edit a task description for a day
Timesheets	Import Preview	Confirm rows before importing a TPG file

Section	Screen	Purpose
Timesheets	Client Picker	Select a client when emailing a timesheet

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End of Guide